

Winter Storm Fern Situation Report - January 2026

Formatted based on LA Fire [Situation Report](#)

Summary

A major American winter storm, often referred to as Winter Storm Fern, started on Friday, January 23 and continued through January 26th. The storm brought heavy snow and freezing rain to several U.S. states, ranging from the southern plains to the Eastern United States. Several states experienced network outages and extremely cold temperatures.

The following visualizations are developed based on Meta AI for Good's data through Facebook. The data covers network coverage and population density from January 27 to February 10, with a focus on Tennessee and Kentucky and daily updates during the collection period.

Movement

% Population Density Change

Note the difference in Figure [1](#), which is based on Bing tiles, and Figure [2](#), which is based on administrative regions.

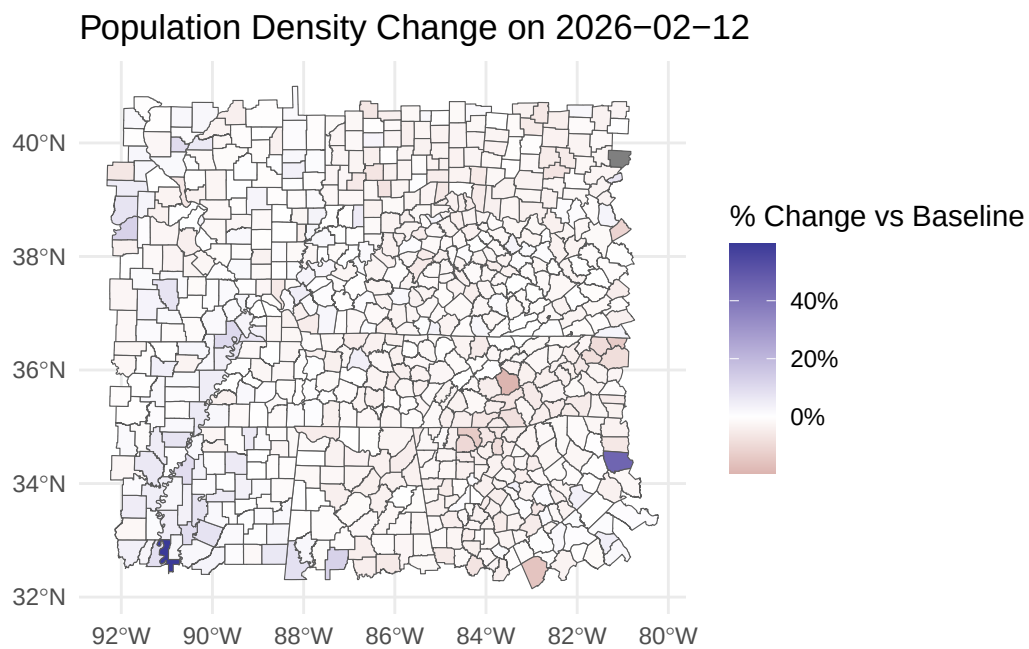


Figure 1: Based on the Bing tiles, there are only a few counties with strong population density changes.

Population Density Change on 2026-02-12

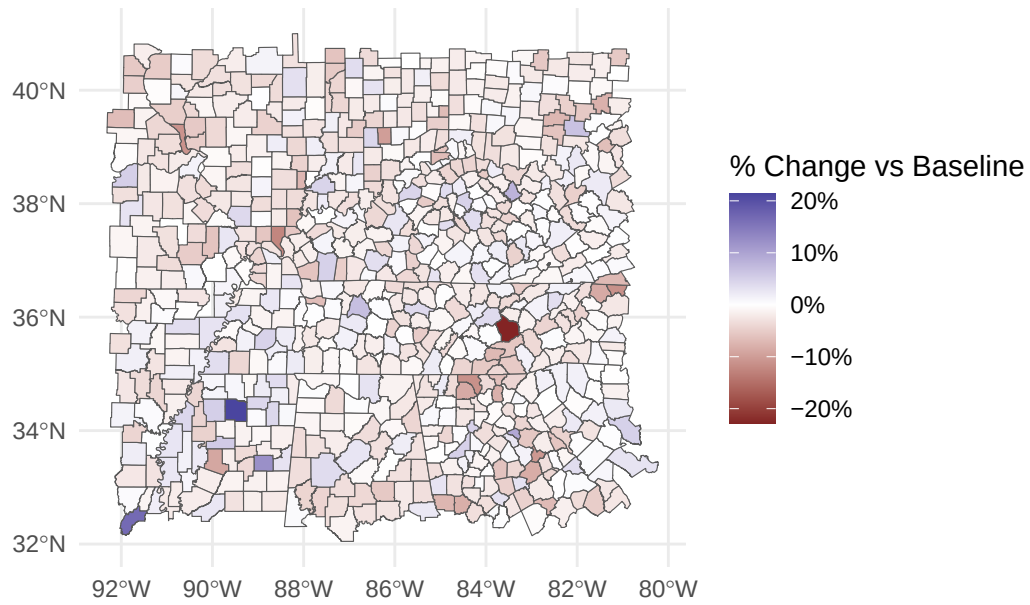


Figure 2: Based on the administrative regions, there are two counties with strong population density changes, one positively and one negatively.

Time Series of Movement

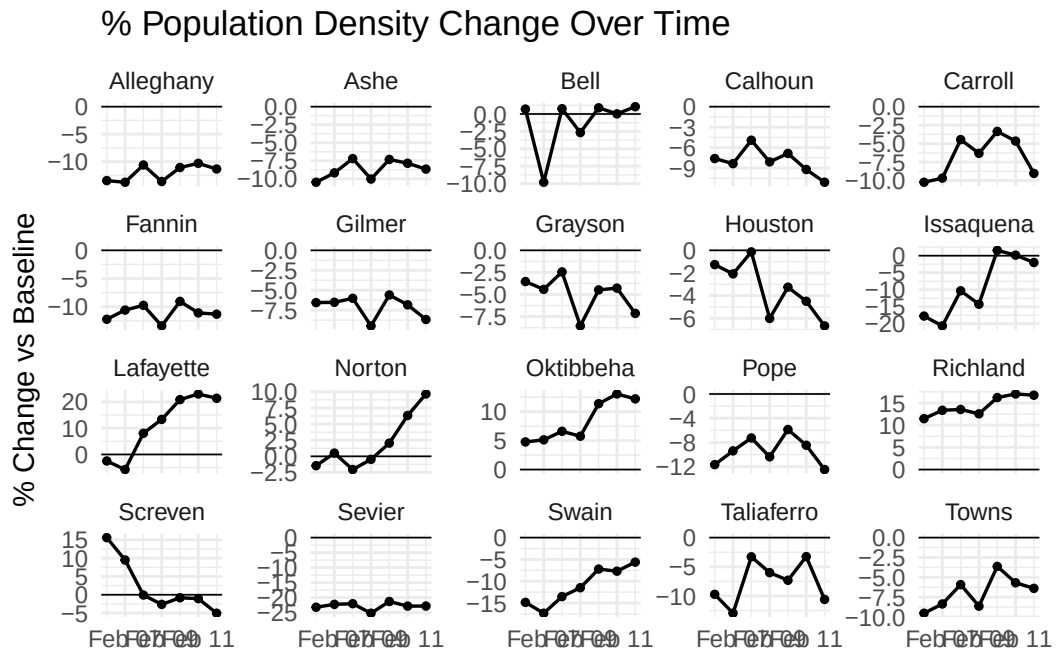


Figure 3: There are strong difference in population changes across different counties

Vulnerability

Power Outages

As shown in Figure 4, ...

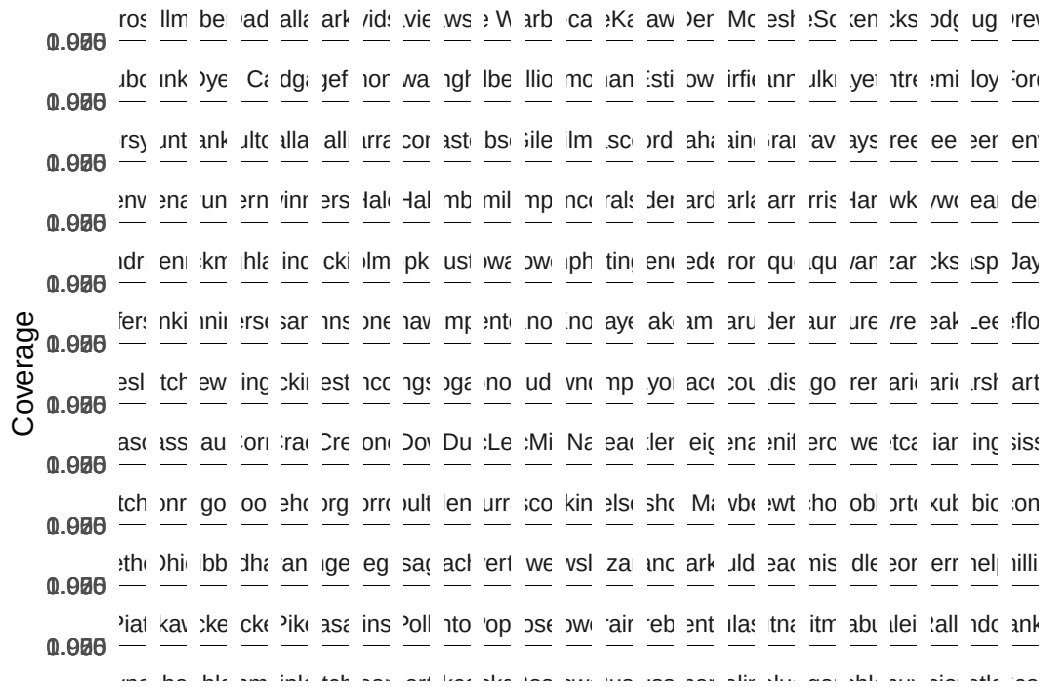


Figure 4: Insert caption here.

Places

As shown by Table 1, ...

Table 1

start_county_name	end_county_name	total_crisis_movement	avg_z_score
Sevier	Russell	0	NaN
Shelby	Woodruff	0	NaN
Smith	Sevier	0	NaN
Spartanburg	Cocke	0	NaN
Sumner	Marion	0	NaN
Swain	Greenville	0	NaN
Tippecanoe	Davidson	0	NaN
Tuscaloosa	Cherokee	0	NaN
Vanderburgh	McCracken	0	NaN
Walker	DeSoto	0	NaN
Warren	Fulton	0	NaN
Watauga	Knox	0	NaN
Weakley	Lake	0	NaN
White	Sevier	0	NaN
Williamson	Gibson	0	NaN
Williamson	Gwinnett	0	NaN
Wood	Fairfield	0	NaN
Wood	Hocking	0	NaN
Wood	Tuscarawas	0	NaN
Wythe	Raleigh	0	NaN